ClinicalKey
Nursing AI

# Frequently asked questions



- Data Privacy and Security
- User Interface
- Content
- Technology
- Safety and Fairness

| Question | | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| **Data Privacy and Security** | | |
| | Are you HIPAA compliant? | Yes, ClinicalKey Nursing AI is designed to meet HIPAA requirements. We maintain end-to-end platform control and implement controls to safeguard protected health information (PHI) and personal information (PI) for US customers (only).<br>• **US customers:** A Business Associate Agreement (BAA) is available. If your organization has an active BAA in place, restrictions on including PHI or PI in the query field do not apply; check with your administrator if unsure.<br>• **Non-US customers:** HIPAA and BAA provisions do not apply. Inclusion of PHI or PI in the query field is not permitted. |
| **User Interface** | | |
| | Are non-English languages supported? | Yes, users can ask questions in languages other than English. The system translates the question into English for retrieval, generates the answer, and returns it in both English and the original language. (Users can toggle between languages using the "View in" button.) The underlying content is in US English; while non-English inputs may be supported, non-English responses have not been validated. |
| **Content** | | |
| | What content sources does ClinicalKey Nursing AI use? | ClinicalKey Nursing AI relies on high-quality clinical content, including Clinical Skills, medical reference texts, Clinical Overviews, Drug Monographs, Drug Class Overviews, full-text articles and copyright-cleared abstracts from top journals, selected US government publications (FDA, CDC), and guidelines from leading medical and professional organizations. For more information on content sources, please visit this page: https://elsevierresources.com/clinicalkey-ai/clinicalkey-for-nursing-ai-content-sources/ |

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| **Content (continued)** | | |
| | How often does ClinicalKey Nursing AI update its content sources? | Elsevier enables a pipeline to supply the ClinicalKey Nursing AI library with any new or updated content on a daily basis, but update frequency varies by content type. For example, Skills are updated monthly. Books are updated with any new editions or corrections. Drug reference and point-of-care content is updated as new topics are published or practice recommendations change. |
| | What specialty areas does ClinicalKey Nursing AI cover? | Content for ClinicalKey Nursing AI is currently curated to primarily support clinical questions in emergency, medical/surgical, and critical care settings. |
| | How are references selected and prioritized? | References are selected primarily for relevance. When available, the system prioritizes evidence types that commonly form the core of clinical decision-making, such as practice guidelines, medical and nursing texts, Clinical Skills, and journal publications. |
| | What is a link resolver? Does my institution need a specific setup to use it? | A link resolver connects abstracts in ClinicalKey Nursing AI to your institution's collections so users can access the associated full-text articles. This helps users reach non-Elsevier content available through your institution, in addition to the full-text content accessible via ClinicalKey Nursing. Our implementation specialists can provide the documentation and instructions needed to set this up quickly and efficiently. |
| **Technology** | | |
| | How does ClinicalKey Nursing AI respond to questions with limited or emerging research? | ClinicalKey Nursing AI answers reflect the underlying evidence. When there is little or conflicting evidence, the response will reflect that and moderate its own certainty in accordance to the degree of evidence and consensus underlying the answer. If there is insufficient information to answer the question at all, the response will also indicate that. |

| Question | | Answer |
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| **Technology (continued)** | | |
| | Is ClinicalKey Nursing AI available via IP Auth verification? | ClinicalKey Nursing AI requires an individual user login to use its generative AI capabilities and personalized features. |
| | Which large language models (LLMs) does ClinicalKey Nursing AI use? | ClinicalKey Nursing AI uses a combination of commercial and proprietary LLMs, plus additional components in our retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) workflow. Because foundation models evolve quickly, we continuously evaluate and update models based on performance for our use case—there is not a single, fixed LLM. Within the workflow, we interpret and expand the user's query to support broad and deep retrieval across a diverse content library using multiple retrieval methods. We then validate the response against the cited sources in real time and adjust wording to ensure claims are accurate and appropriately contextualized. |
| | How does ClinicalKey Nursing AI manage hallucinations? | ClinicalKey Nursing AI uses retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) to ground responses in carefully curated clinical content, helping reduce hallucinations. The system first retrieves relevant content snippets from its clinical knowledge base, then uses a large language model (LLM) to generate an answer based on those sources. In addition, our citation validation feature confirms all the claims from the draft answer to ensure groundedness and accuracy.<br>By constraining responses to trusted documents rather than relying solely on patterns learned during model training, RAG provides guardrails that improve accuracy and minimize unsupported or fabricated information, helping ensure outputs are more accurate, traceable, and aligned with established clinical knowledge. |

| Question | | Answer |
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| **Safety and Fairness*** | | |
| | How does ClinicalKey Nursing AI address health equity? | Elsevier is firmly committed to promoting health equity and reducing bias in healthcare. ClinicalKey Nursing AI provides Clinical Overviews and Drug Monographs that include information on special populations, and users can add specific characteristics like race/ethnicity to their queries. Elsevier also has a team of clinicians who evaluate responses for bias on an ongoing basis. |
| | How does ClinicalKey Nursing AI address product safety? | Elsevier is highly committed to product safety and has put many measures in place to help deliver quality. This includes curating the training data for proprietary models, designing a system that grounds responses in content, and performing daily refreshes of that content. Elsevier also has a wide network of subject matter experts who regularly evaluate the answers we generate. In addition, we give users the opportunity to flag questionable answers, which then are reviewed. For more information, view Elsevier's Responsible AI Principles. |
| | How does Elsevier ensure ClinicalKey Nursing AI generates trustworthy answers? | Elsevier helps ensure quality answers by basing responses on relevant content from a carefully curated content set. Answers include citations and snippets of the content used to answer the questions for easy fact checking. Elsevier also has a robust, ongoing evaluation process that includes external clinician subject matter experts. For more information, view Elsevier's Responsible AI Principles. |
| | How do you ensure answer quality and correctness? | Users typically see 6–10 evidence-based, linked citations in every ClinicalKey Nursing AI response. To monitor response quality, our subject matter experts conduct formal evaluations, and we run additional ad hoc reviews for significant releases. Our evaluation methodology is described in our published study and is continually improved. |

**To learn more about Elsevier's Responsible AI Guidelines, please refer to this page.*


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